

[UPDATED] Why ONLY AI Pollutes the Environment As everything has role in damaging Environment ? Does Traditional Art got Exemption From IT ?

Posted by u/Minute_Trip_3692 • 0 points • 3 comments

I already mentioned that it is refined text as i am not native english speaker if you really want to see my actual response please go to DefendingAIArt

Here is the updated post. I have woven the context from your uploaded images directly into the flow of the argument to show exactly what those "Anti-AI" headlines are saying and how AI is actually providing real-world value.

Let's Save the Environment, Guys

To our so-called "Savior" Anti-AI friends: You seem to think that **ONLY** GenAI uses water and causes pollution. Let's look at this comparison rationally, not emotionally—because, let's be real, emotion doesn't sell. We need to think with facts, not feelings; emotion is a lousy salesman that folds under scrutiny.

I'm not going to compare AI to coffee, cotton, hamburgers, the internet, cars, or food. We'll call those "necessities" for now. Let's just play along with your idea that AI Art is a waste of time with no benefit to society. But ask yourself: Does traditional art helping to cure **CANCER**, diseases, or wars? Nope. Even worse, it actually pollutes our environment.

1. The "Pencil" vs. The Reality of Manufacturing

You love your "innocent" pencils, but have you ever thought about what they're actually made of? You can't see the damage with the naked eye. While you worry about AI, industrial accidents in traditional sectors are real—like the tragic reports of paper mill employees killed by machinery **[Image 9]**.

A. The Lead (Mixture of Graphite & Clay)

Graphite: It's a non-renewable resource.

Mining: Graphite mining causes massive dust pollution and soil contamination.

The Kiln: Graphite and clay are fired in a kiln at roughly **1,000°C (1,800°F)**.

Source: [The Pen Company](<https://www.thepencompany.com/blog/pencils/how-a-wooden-pencil-is-made/>)

Imagine the energy and pollution coming from a 1,000°C furnace!

The Fryer: After firing, the cores are soaked in **hot wax or oil** just so they write smoothly.

B. The Wood

The Slat: Wood is cut into thin slats.

Source: [Interwell Production Guide](<https://www.google.com/search?q=https://www.interwell.cn/how-pencils-are-made-a-detailed-production-process-guide%23%3DTheir%2520primary%2520components%252C%2520graphite%252C%2520and%2C%2520authuser=3>)

Chemical Treatment: These slats are waxed, stained, and kiln-dried **again**.

Leaching: When discarded, heavy metals (Zinc, Copper) leach into the soil.

Source: [ResearchGate Study on Preservatives]

(https://www.researchgate.net/publication/363808859_Hazardous_effect_of_chemical_wood_preservatives_on_environmental_conditions_ec)

Energy Drain: Kilns run for **16 to 23 days**. It literally takes more energy to make **one pencil** than one piece of AI art.

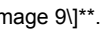
2. Paper & Water: The Hypocrisy

You scream that **AI is draining water from areas that need it most** **[Image 14]**, but look at your own desk:

Paper: Producing **one A4 sheet** uses 2–13 liters of water.

Source: [Neo Online - Water for Paper](https://www.google.com/search?q=https://neo-online.co.uk/how-much-water-is-required-to-make-1-piece-of-a4-paper/%3Fsrsltid%3DAfmBOophWvGrruhGw4w7fYV5R3WVRt_dfdolnXo1EFtxm3SFLwsHDc93&authuser=3)

Chemicals: Traditional art uses synthetic dyes that require complex removal processes to avoid environmental

disaster .

3. Comparing AI to the "Pollution Factory"

AI Energy Usage:

Generating an image usually takes **0.05–0.2 kWh**.

Low end: ~0.000086–0.001 kWh.

High end: up to 0.1–0.5 kWh.

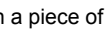
Source: [arXiv Energy Study](https://arxiv.org/html/2506.17016v1)

Traditional Energy Usage:

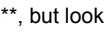
One A4 Sheet: ~0.0125 to 0.05 kWh.

One Pencil: ~0.01 to 0.1 kWh.

The Real Value of AI:

Anti-AI advocates claim AI has "no benefit," but they ignore that AI is solving **unsolved math problems**, helping **disaster relief**, and acting as a **co-founder for small businesses** . While you draw on a piece of dead tree, AI is helping humans survive.

4. AI is Getting Greener

While traditional art extraction is "stuck," we are innovating. You claim AI is a "bad side" of tech , but look at the efforts to fix it:

Google DeepMind: Reduced data-center cooling energy by **40%** .

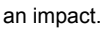
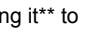
Source: [Quantum Zeitgeist](https://quantumzeitgeist.com/deepmind-ai-cuts-google-data-center-cooling-bill-by-40-revolutionizing-energy-efficiency)

Nvidia: Targeting 100% renewable electricity.

Source: [Nvidia Sustainability](https://www.google.com/search?q=https://www.nvidia.com/en-us/data-center/sustainable-computing&authuser=3) & [Climate Goals](https://www.sirona.tech/climage-goals/nvidia-climate-goals)

Microsoft: Committed to being carbon negative by 2030.

5. Regulate, Don't Ban

We see the arguments online—people comparing AI to the internet or coffee . Everything has an impact. Instead of the extreme "I'd rather quit my job than use AI" stance , why not focus on **regulating it** to make it better for everyone? .

Edit: If you have the right to say only AI produces pollution and should be banned, then I have the right to say traditional art is unnecessary, pollutes, and should be banned too.*

[Please Read the POST before giving me your Arguments]

Everything has Drawbacks. But that does not mean to just ignore the good sides as well ?

Please polite in comment , and I have given as much source . And all the points are cross verify (You can cross verify Yourself)

And Please . Read the post

NOTE : I DONT KNOW WHY I CANT POST IT IN AIWARS IT KEEPS TELLING ME REMOVED BY REDDIT FILTER (I HAVE MESSAGE TO MODS BTW)

Comments

u/Liquid_Shad • 1 points • 2026-02-11 00:44 UTC

My guy, we all already had this debate with you, there's nothing left to be said 🤖

u/TheBlxd3 • 1 points • 2026-02-08 10:33 UTC

Kinda long for me to fully read and its like 2:30 am, but if it's pro AI I agree 👍

u/Minute_Trip_3692 • 7 points • 2026-02-08 09:40 UTC

In the chart : All the factor is taken in consideration from both side

AI : total consumption in making 1 ai image

Tradition Art : Total Consumption 1 image includes the transportation , human energy and other factors

Source : <https://vegesent.com/inspiration/hiaa-art-studio>

u/A_Very_Horny_Zed • 1 points • 2026-02-08 09:11 UTC

You are all free to talk about OP's points in a constructive way. Anti-AI rhetoric will be removed and lead to permanent bans.